

**Aparna
Sharma**

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Work Experience

PhD Candidate & Teaching Assistant

Department of Digital Humanities and Societal Systems, International Institute of Information Technology Bangalore

Bengaluru, India | July 2023 – Present

- Completed doctoral coursework in Human–Computer Interaction, Qualitative Research Methods, Political Economy of Technology, Urban Studies, and Cognitive Psychology. Currently serve as a Teaching Assistant for the course *Social Pathways to Information Technology*.
- Support the delivery of on-campus and digital instruction, including assisting with course facilitation, student engagement, and elements of instructional design.
- Conduct qualitative research on user experiences with online dating platforms in India using in-depth interviews and app walkthrough methods to analyse user behaviour and interaction patterns.
- Led usability research on Samsung Quick Share, designing and conducting user studies and collaborating with cross-functional teams to improve feature usability and user satisfaction.
- Work with interdisciplinary teams to support departmental talks and conferences, contribute to social media outreach, assist with data analysis projects, and support user-experience research initiatives.

Research & Teaching Assistant — Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, BITS Pilani (K.K. Birla Goa Campus) Goa, India | 2021 – 2022

- Completed MPhil research in Social Anthropology; dissertation was an ethnographic study of intimacy and consumption culture among the urban middle class in India — foundational work that informs the theoretical concerns of the current PhD project.
- Conducted supplementary research on local disease goddesses and epidemic/pandemic imaginaries in India, engaging questions of embodiment, risk, and popular religion.
- Supported teaching across undergraduate courses in the Humanities and Social Sciences, assisting lectures and seminars for cohorts of 150+ students.
- Contributed to departmental operations including academic events, outreach, and communications.

Project Assistant — Academic and Outreach Division, Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA), Bangalore, Bengaluru, India | 2019 – 2021

- Assisted research, documentation, and fieldwork across 6 academic projects in collaboration with partner institutions including INTACH, NIAS Bangalore, Chitrakala Parishath, Hampi University, and Bangalore University.
- Coordinated and delivered online PG Diploma courses, managing instructional design, educator liaison, and course logistics end-to-end.
- Planned and executed academic events, outreach initiatives, and cultural programmes in partnership with research and non-profit organisations.
- Managed digital communications including social media, email marketing, and weekly newsletters; ran Facebook Ad campaigns with demonstrably high conversion rates.

Content Marketing Executive — Volunteering Solutions, Gurugram 2014–15 | 2018–19 (two tenures; expanded scope on return)

- On return (2018–19), took on a broader remit spanning sales, operations liaison, and business development — coordinating directly with university field trip and service-learning verticals across the US, Europe, Australia, and New Zealand to convert institutional partnerships into student enrolments.
- Served as primary point of contact for prospective student volunteers, achieving 90%+ conversion through email and video outreach.
- Managed content creation, SEO, and digital marketing across three websites; ran Facebook Ad campaigns and maintained engagement through alumni communities.
- Conducted fieldwork for social impact campaigns across India, Nepal, and Thailand, including focus group discussions and in-depth interviews.
- Collaborated across Sales, Digital Marketing, and Operations teams; awarded Most Promising New Employee on first tenure.

Education

BITS Pilani, K.K. Birla Goa Campus — MPhil, Liberal Studies | 2021–22 Thesis: *"Tinder, Tradition & True Love: Rise of Online Dating Culture in Urban, Middle-Class India"*

Tata Institute of Social Sciences, Hyderabad — MA, Women's Studies | 2018 Awarded *Best Dissertation* among the outgoing cohort of 30 students.

University of Delhi — BA (Hons.), English Literature | 2011–14

Mater Dei Convent School, New Delhi — CBSE Class X & XII | 2009–11

Skills

Research: Qualitative & quantitative methods, ethnography, user interviews, walkthrough sessions, focus group discussions, in-depth interviews; NVivo, Atlas.ti; R (basic quantitative analysis)

Writing & Communication: Academic writing, content writing, editing, proofreading, instructional design

Digital: SEO, social media marketing, email marketing, Facebook & Google Ad Manager, Mailchimp, Canva